In the Guise of a Conclusion

I admit that the coming days are hidden from me in deep fog. Let me nonetheless attempt to say how I imagine a possible future. Hopefully, a better future. Of course, it could be that the war will end without the destruction of Hamas, as a result of American and other pressure on Israel, or simply because this kind of terrorist organization cannot be destroyed under existing conditions, be it to save the hostages, or because of the impossibility of eradicating the tunnels, or because of the conditions of warfare in such a densely populated environment, or as a result of all these factors. This would imply difficult times ahead for Israel, a sort of permanent state of alert that could last for years, due to what happened on October 7, notwithstanding all the international guarantees that could be given.

The other possibility looks as follows. The leadership of Hamas, ensconced underground up to now, will probably escape (or be allowed to escape) to some Islamic country. The major questions pertain to what comes afterward. When the fighting dies down, the main problems return to the fore.

As far as Israel is concerned, there is one most urgent question: where are the hostages? They have to be released immediately, maybe as a guarantee of safe escape for the leadership of Hamas. Then, and only then, can the other issues be discussed.

First among those, how will massive help be most urgently extended to the desperate Gaza civilians, and then what countries and agencies will take over the physical reconstruction of the enclave? Then, and for Israel this is a